

ANNIVERSARY
EDITION



Officially 10 Years

Hope and Rural Aid Foundation

HARAF MONTHLY BULLETIN

March 2026



INTRODUCTION

Hope and Rural Aid Foundation (HARAF) is a humanitarian, non-profit, and non-governmental organization committed to improving the lives of vulnerable and underserved communities. Established in 2011, HARAF has built a strong track record of delivering impactful interventions across key sectors, including livelihoods, health, education, and community development.

In 2016, the organization was formally registered with the Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC) of the Federal Republic of Nigeria under registration number CAC/IT/85536, further strengthening its institutional credibility and compliance with national regulatory standards.

Driven by a vision of sustainable development and human dignity, HARAF continues to design and implement innovative, community-centered programs that foster resilience, empower individuals, and promote inclusive growth.

HARAF PRESENCE | Adamawa, Borno, Yobe, Sokoto

THEMATIC AREAS

Health

Education

Livelihood

Mainstreaming
Protection



Reaching the Unreached without Barrier

In March 2026, livelihood technical sessions were effectively delivered with the at the Fufore and Girei Livelihood Incubation Centres (LICs), providing participants with structured, progressive, and hands-on training across key value chains.

In fish farming, participants gained practical and technical expertise in nutrition, feed formulation, health management, and sorting techniques, strengthening their capacity to improve productivity, reduce mortality, and enhance operational efficiency.

Crop and vegetable production sessions equipped participants with essential skills in nursery establishment, water management, and organic pest control, enabling improved crop yields, reduced production risks, and more sustainable farming practices.

Goat farming training focused on feeding, breeding, fattening, and preventive health management, empowering participants to enhance herd productivity, improve animal health, and increase income potential.

Poultry production sessions highlighted poultry as a critical source of nutrition and income, while promoting sustainable practices such as manure composting to improve soil fertility and reduce production costs.

Throughout March, the sessions reached **90 (34 Male and 56 Female) participants** across five communities in Fufore and Girei LGAs, demonstrating strong engagement and sustained participation. This broad outreach reflects the programme's effective community penetration and its commitment to building inclusive, community-level capacity in livelihood development across the targeted areas.

Overall, the sessions significantly strengthened participants' technical capacity, promoting sustainable, productive, and income-generating livelihood practices.

Location	No. of Females	No of Males	Males ^{PWD}	Females	Total
Goat Production	7	10	1	1	17
Fish Production	8	7	3	-	15
Poultry Production	16	7	-	1	23
Crop/Vegetables Production	24	11	1	-	35





Rice planting session with project participants in Fufore LIC



Reaching the Unreached without Barrier

SEXUAL REPRODUCTIVE HEALTH AND RIGHT - SRHR

Life Skills Sessions

In March 2026, the HARAF SRHR team, in collaboration with community PALS facilitators, successfully implemented a series of life skills sessions for adolescents and parents across five intervention communities **Fufore, Gurin, Girei 1 & 2, and Jabi Lamba** through the Conrad N. Hilton Funded Project. The sessions were strategically designed to equip participants with the knowledge, attitudes, and skills required to make informed decisions for improved health, wellbeing, and positive family relationships.

Across four progressive PALS sessions, both adolescents and parents actively engaged in structured, participatory learning modules. Adolescents were supported to build self-awareness, understand their social support networks, recognize and manage emotions, and develop positive coping strategies for stress. These sessions created safe spaces that encouraged open dialogue, peer learning, and confidence building.

For parents and caregivers, the sessions strengthened parenting capacity through practical guidance on stress management, self-care, understanding adolescent development, and adopting positive communication and support strategies. Participants gained critical insights into the physical, emotional, and social needs of adolescents, particularly within challenging and crisis-affected contexts.

The sessions recorded strong participation and engagement, with participants demonstrating enthusiasm, sharing experiences, and applying practical skills through interactive activities, a total of **200 participants were reached, including 100 adolescents (41 Male, 59 Female) and 100 parents (27 Male, 73 Female)**. Overall, the intervention established a solid foundation for improved adolescent wellbeing, strengthened caregiver support systems, and enhanced family cohesion within the target communities.



200
Participants



100 Adolescent
41 Male/59 Female



100 Adolescent
27 Male/73 Female





Health And Nutrition Education For Pregnant Women – Runjin Sambo PHC

As part of sustained efforts to improve maternal and child health outcomes, HARAF successfully delivered targeted health and nutrition education sessions at Runjin Sambo Primary Health Centre (PHC). The intervention effectively engaged both newly registered and returning ANC clients, driving increased early ANC uptake, improved adherence to care schedules, and strengthened adoption of positive maternal health practices.

The sessions provided comprehensive guidance on the importance of consistent use of pregnancy supplements, early ANC registration, and timely reporting of complications. Participants were equipped with practical knowledge on balanced nutrition, emphasizing the intake of protein, fruits, and vegetables essential for healthy maternal and fetal development. Preventive health measures, including the consistent use of insecticide-treated nets (ITNs) and improved hygiene and sanitation practices, were strongly reinforced to reduce health risks.

In addition, the sessions promoted proactive health-seeking behavior, encouraging pregnant women to promptly access care at the PHC when experiencing any discomfort or warning signs during pregnancy.

Key Achievements:

- **26 new ANC registrations and consultations recorded**
- **122 follow-up ANC consultations conducted**
- **148 pregnant women reached with ANC and nutrition education**
- **34 safe deliveries attended by skilled health personnel**
- **4 pregnant women tested, treated, and counselled for STDs**

The intervention significantly strengthened awareness, service utilization, and positive health behaviours among pregnant women, contributing to improved maternal and neonatal health outcomes.



Reaching the Unreached without Barrier

Mobile Health and RCCE Outreach Activities - DIKWA

In March, HARA/NHF Mobile Health Teams (MHTs) in Dikwa were strategically deployed to Masarmari Camp, Fulatari Camp, and Kasugula host community, ensuring uninterrupted delivery of essential healthcare services to vulnerable and hard-to-reach populations. This targeted approach effectively addressed critical gaps in access to healthcare, particularly in areas with limited or non-functional health facilities.

Through well-coordinated outreach schedules, MHTs delivered a comprehensive package of primary healthcare services, including outpatient consultations, treatment of common illnesses, basic case management, referrals for complicated cases, maternal and child health services, and integrated health education. A total of **2,411 individuals (1,576 Female; 835 male)** were reached, spanning IDPs and returnee populations.

The intervention significantly boosted healthcare utilization, with community members accessing timely, quality services within close proximity, thereby minimizing access barriers. Complementing clinical service delivery, RCCE teams were actively engaged across all locations to strengthen community awareness and promote positive health-seeking behaviours. Using participatory and community-friendly approaches, sessions focused on hygiene promotion, disease prevention, maternal and child health, early care-seeking practices, and awareness of available services.

These engagements recorded strong participation, particularly among women and caregivers, resulting in increased awareness and improved uptake of services. A total of **2,070 individuals (1,693 Female; 378 male)** were reached through RCCE activities.

These integrated implementations of MHT and RCCE interventions delivered a robust and holistic approach, effectively combining curative and preventive services to enhance health outcomes and community engagement across the targeted locations.



**Distribution of
clean delivery kits
& surgical treatment
at Kasugula PHC
Dikwa LGA**





Mobile Health Team during OPD consultation in Masarmari Kasugula

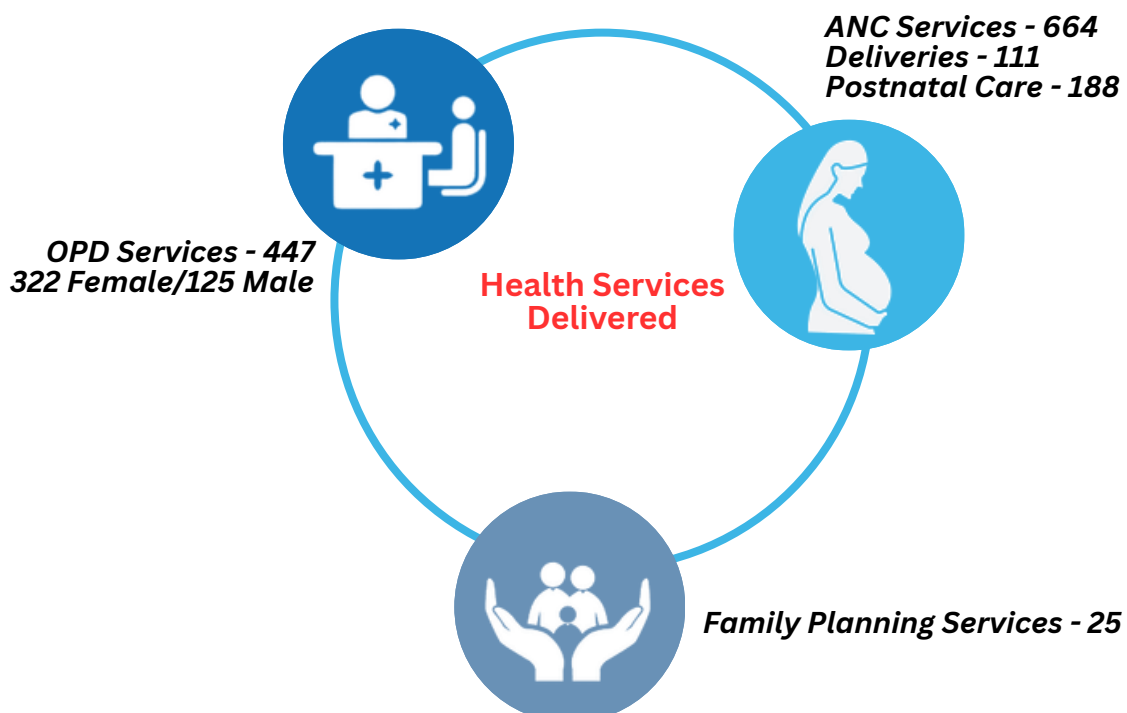
Health Facility Service Delivery

Also during the reporting period, HARAF team strengthened facility-based service delivery through the deployment of qualified support staff to health facilities serving Masarmari Camp, Fulatari Camp, and Kasugula host community. This strategic support enhanced service availability, improved patient flow, and ensured the consistent delivery of quality healthcare to vulnerable populations.

Comprehensive Outpatient Department (OPD) services were provided, addressing common illnesses such as malaria, respiratory tract infections, and diarrheal diseases, with a notable increase in acute respiratory infection cases recorded in March. A total of **447 (322 Female, 125 Male)** individuals accessed OPD services across the supported facilities.

Sexual and Reproductive Health (SRH) services were also delivered in line with minimum standards, including antenatal care, safe delivery support, postnatal care, and family planning services. In total **664 (624 Female and 40 Male)**, **410 beneficiaries** received ANC services, **111 deliveries** were supported, **118 individuals** accessed postnatal care, and **25 clients** benefited from family planning services.

Health education and awareness sessions were integrated within facility services, promoting improved health-seeking behaviours, hygiene practices, and maternal and child health.



Capacity Building and Community Engagement - MADAGALI

In the month of March HARAF protection team on NHF Madagali Project conducted a targeted capacity-building activities for frontline service providers, including OPD staff, teachers, and caregivers across Shuwa, Duhu, and Gulak communities. The training strengthened local systems for early identification, safe disclosure, and effective response to GBV and child protection concerns. Key focus areas included child rights, safe parenting practices, and early warning signs of abuse and violence, enhancing participants' ability to provide survivor-centered support. A total of **86 individuals (11 Male, 75 Female)** were reached.

Complementary community sensitization sessions on GBV prevention and risk mitigation engaged **590 individuals (163 Male, 427 Female)**, promoting inclusive participation, improving awareness, and encouraging positive behavioural change. The sessions also strengthened knowledge on referral pathways and available support services, contributing to increased community ownership and responsiveness to protection issues.

In addition, psychosocial support activities were conducted for children in Duhu community, reaching 38 participants, and supporting emotional wellbeing through structured recreational engagement. Psychological First Aid (PFA) was also provided to vulnerable households, offering immediate emotional support and strengthening coping mechanisms.

These interventions significantly enhanced the capacity of both frontline actors and community members to prevent, identify, and respond to GBV and child protection risks, contributing to safer and more resilient communities

CCCM Activities

Also during the reporting period, CCCM team effectively implemented across targeted communities, reaching 664 (174 Male, 490 Female) individuals including men, women, boys, and girls from IDP, returnee, host community populations, and persons with disabilities. The activities focused on strengthening community structures, enhancing coordination, and promoting inclusive participation in service delivery.

Key efforts included capacity strengthening of community leadership structures through targeted engagement sessions, which reached 31 community representatives across Gulak, Shuwa, and Duhu. These sessions improved leadership capacity, accountability, and coordination with humanitarian actors.

To ensure community voices informed programming, 122 individuals participated in Focus Group Discussions (FGDs), providing critical insights on service gaps, protection concerns, and priority needs. These engagements supported more responsive and community-driven interventions.

In addition, the formalization of community roles was strengthened through the signing of Terms of Reference (ToRs) with 6 representatives, reinforcing governance structures, clarity of responsibilities, and collaboration mechanisms.

Hygiene promotion activities were also conducted, reaching 505 individuals, and improving awareness and adoption of safe hygiene practices across the communities.

Overall, CCCM interventions significantly enhanced community engagement, strengthened local governance systems, and improved coordination, contributing to more inclusive, accountable, and effective service delivery across the targeted locations.



HARAF Protection Staff during Sensitization/Awareness Session on Child Protection Issues at Shawa Community. Photo-Ian Oelton



HARAF PSS Facilitator during Focused Group Discussion with Adolescents students at Duhu Community. Photo-Harold



Community-Based Menstrual Health and Engagement Activities

SPS HARAF team During this reporting period, through the community-led sensitization activities by the community facilitator on menstrual health and dignity were effectively implemented across Saminaka, Yolde Pate, and Damare IDP Camp, strengthening awareness, improving knowledge, and promoting positive behavioural change among women, adolescent girls, and community members. A community volunteer facilitated a sensitization Islamic gathering in Saminaka community, integrating key messages on menstrual health and dignity.

The session, supported by the SPS team, reached 120 participants and successfully used a culturally appropriate platform to address misconceptions, promote menstrual hygiene management, and encourage open dialogue. Participants demonstrated strong engagement and expressed appreciation for the interactive approach.

A supervisory visit conducted on 17/03/2026 in Yolde Pate further reinforced menstrual health messaging during a sensitization session for 49 participants. The session was highly participatory, with improved understanding observed and misconceptions effectively addressed.

In addition, a community entry engagement was conducted at Damare IDP Camp to formally introduce the project and secure community buy-in. The session, attended by 10 stakeholders (6 females, 4 males), outlined planned menstrual health sensitization activities and emphasized a community-led, peer-based implementation approach. The community expressed strong acceptance and commitment to support the intervention.

These engagements demonstrated the effectiveness of leveraging community structures, religious platforms, and participatory approaches to advance menstrual health awareness.



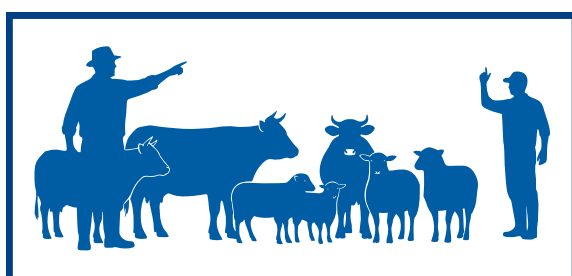
CAHWs/VPPs Service Delivery in Adamawa State (March 2026)

In March 2026, HARAF funded by PROPCOM+ through Community Animal Health Workers (CAHWs) and Veterinary Paraprofessionals (VPPs) successfully delivered critical livestock health services to approximately 14,985 smallholder poultry and livestock farmers across targeted communities in Adamawa State. Through coordinated outreach, these frontline animal health workers expanded access to essential veterinary interventions, strengthening livestock productivity and household resilience.

Operating across key LGAs including Ganye, Guyuk, Gombi, Girei, Fufore, Madagali, Numan, Lamurde, Mubi North, Mubi South, Yola North, and Yola South, about 60 trained animal health personnel ensured sustained community-level service delivery.

Key interventions included the administration of priority vaccines such as Newcastle Disease (NCD) for poultry, Peste des Petits Ruminants (PPR) for small ruminants, and Contagious Bovine Pleuropneumonia (CBPP) for cattle. In addition, farmers benefited from a comprehensive package of animal health services including treatment of sick animals, wound management, castration, dehorning, debeaking, and routine advisory support on improved husbandry practices.

Service delivery was strengthened through effective cold chain management systems, ensuring vaccine potency from storage to field administration. The intervention was implemented through a community-based vaccination model, leveraging CAHWs and VPPs to provide door-to-door and village-level outreach, which significantly improved coverage and community trust.



***Through CAHWs & VPPs, 14,985
Smallholder Livestock farmers were
REACHED across targeted communities
in Adamawa State.***



Livelihoods Mentorship & Follow-up Support (Adamawa State, March 2026)

In March 2026, HARAF/PLAN Livelihood Team conducted mentorship and follow-up support for kitchen garden and seed capital beneficiaries across six communities in Adamawa State, reaching 145 participants (75 kitchen garden and 70 seed capital beneficiaries).

The intervention focused on strengthening technical and business skills, monitoring progress, and addressing implementation challenges. Positive outcomes included improved gardening practices, crop diversification, and increased resilience among participants, with several adopting adaptive strategies such as relocation of gardens to improve water access.

Key challenges identified included deterioration of gardening inputs (notably protective nets), pest infestations, depletion of quality seeds, and limited access to farmland in some locations. In addition, the team supported a bi-annual conflict scan across four communities and contributed to agribusiness training for 200 youth participants aimed at strengthening livelihood opportunities and economic resilience.

The mentorship exercise enhanced beneficiary capacity and generated key insights to inform improved programme delivery and sustainability.

(75 kitchen Garden



70 Seed Capital

Mentorship & Follow-up Support 145 Participants

SRHR Outreach Activities - Borno State

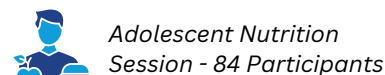
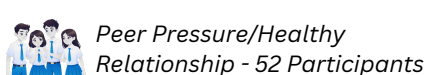
In March 2026, the SRHR team conducted a series of structured awareness and sensitization sessions across Damboa and Mafa LGAs, reaching adolescents and caregivers through school outreach and Family Support Clinics/PHCs. Key thematic areas included peer pressure and healthy relationships, drug abuse, gender-based violence (GBV), and adolescent nutrition.

Sessions focused on strengthening adolescents' knowledge and life skills, promoting positive behavior change, and improving awareness of available adolescent-friendly health services. Participants were also introduced to PHC family support clinics and encouraged to access services confidently.

Across all sessions, adolescents demonstrated improved understanding of peer influence, risks associated with drug abuse, prevention of GBV, and the importance of balanced nutrition for healthy growth and reproductive wellbeing. Strong engagement was recorded, particularly among girls and young women across both LGAs.

A total of 206 participants were reached for drug abuse sessions, 52 for GBV sensitization, 52 for peer pressure and healthy relationships, and 84 for adolescent nutrition sessions across Damboa and Mafa LGAs. Attendance was primarily composed of adolescents (10–18 years), with additional participation from young women and a small number of caregivers and IDPs.

The interventions strengthened adolescents' awareness of SRHR issues, promoted healthy decision-making, and reinforced access to youth-friendly services, contributing to improved wellbeing and risk reduction in the targeted communities.



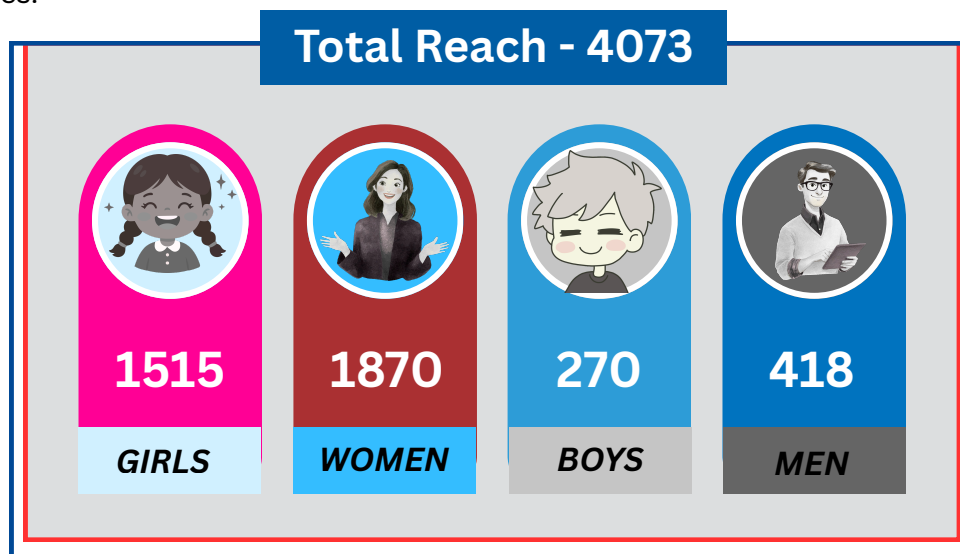
SRHR Social Marketing & Youth-Friendly Health Services

In March 2026, the SRHR team in Adamawa conducted a social marketing distribution at Jabbi/Lamba PHCC, providing essential sexual and reproductive health commodities to adolescents and young people. Items distributed included sanitary pads, towels, cotton wool, gloves, soap, and syringe/needle sets. The intervention aimed to improve access to essential SRH supplies, strengthen hygiene practices, and promote safe, informed health behaviors among young people.

Throughout March 2026, across Adamawa and Borno adolescents and youths in Girei, Malabu, Jabbi Lamba, Ribadu, Alkaleri, Simari and Kaleri communities continued to access a comprehensive package of youth-friendly SRH services through supported PHC facilities. Services included antenatal care, safe deliveries and postnatal care, family planning, STI management, and psychosocial counselling reaching a total of 4073 (1515 girls, 1870 women, 270 boys and 418 men).

These services were delivered by trained health workers under the Adolescents and Youth Friendly Health Services (AYFHS) model, supported by Plan International and HARAF, ensuring a safe, confidential, and responsive environment for young clients.

The intervention strengthened access to quality SRH services, improved health-seeking behavior among adolescents and youths, and contributed to enhanced awareness and uptake of family planning, STI prevention, and maternal health services across the supported communities.





PALS Cohorts 11 & 12 (Borno & Adamawa States, March 2026)

In March 2026, the PALS programme for Cohorts 11 and 12 was successfully implemented across selected communities in Borno and Adamawa States, delivering structured life skills and parenting sessions to adolescents and caregivers.

A total of 6 and 4 adolescent sessions and 3 and 4 parenting sessions across Borno and Adamawa communities respectively were conducted, covering key themes including Puberty and Menstruation, pregnancy and safe sex, violence prevention and response, child early and forced marriage, Protecting Adolescents from violence, and future aspirations. The sessions strengthened adolescents' knowledge, decision-making capacity, and confidence to seek support, while promoting positive behaviour change and resilience reaching 288 adolescents and 288 parents participated in structured sessions across Kaleri, Simari, Alkaleri, Shuwari, Girei, Ribadu, Jabbi-Lamba, and Malabu communities. The sessions established safe and inclusive spaces while strengthening adolescents' ability to set personal goals. Participants also acquired practical skills to resist negative peer pressure and identify safe and healthy relationships, including understanding consent and responding to harmful behaviors.

Caregivers were equally engaged and equipped with practical skills to improve communication, strengthen protection of adolescents, and support healthy development within the home. Key focus areas included adolescent SRHR, safeguarding, and prevention of harmful practices. These interventions significantly improved SRHR awareness, protection knowledge, and parent adolescent communication contributing to safer environments and improved wellbeing for adolescents across all target communities



Cross Section of PALS Cohorts 11 & 12 during a Session



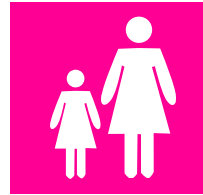
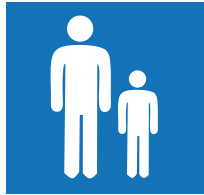
TOTAL REACH IN MARCH



Total Reach for
all Projects - 28,450

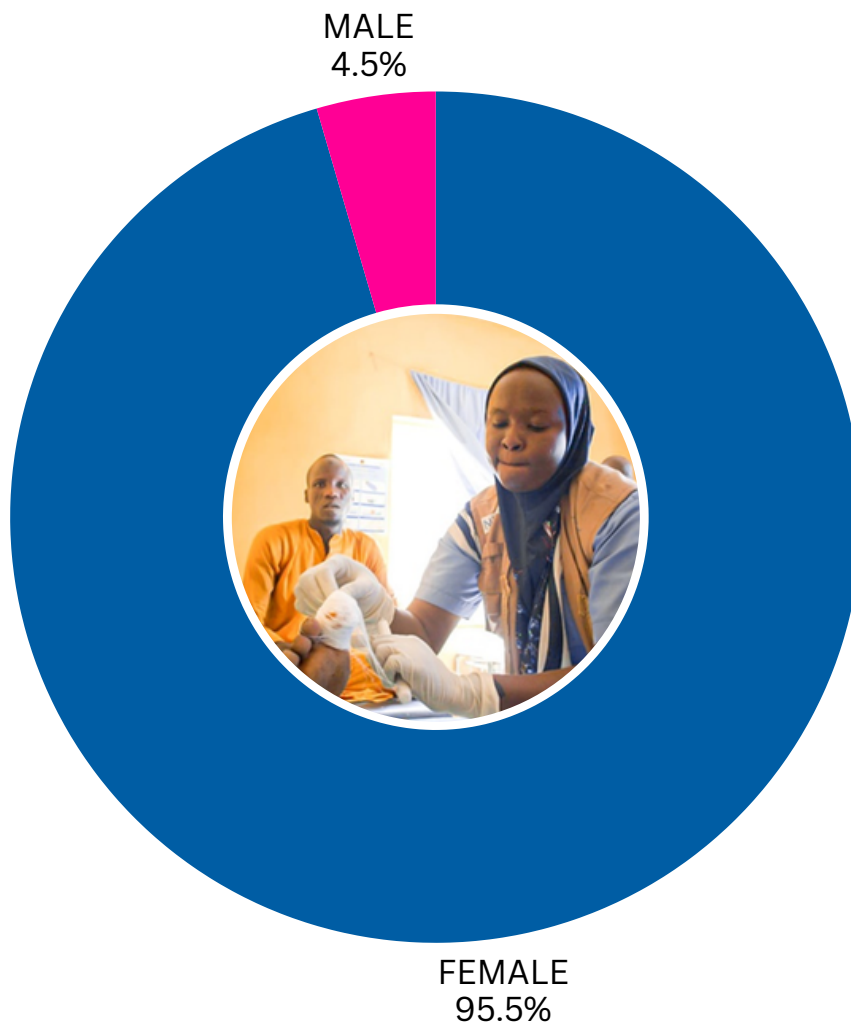
Total Male
Reached - 2,597

Men - 2,173
Boys - 42



Total Female
Reached - 25,853

Women - 24,120
Girls - 1,733





HEAD OFFICE

Mallamre Quarters,
Former UNHCR Office,
Jimeta - Yola, Adamawa State.

Maiduguri Sub-Office

Gombole Road,
After Capital School,
Before Giwa Barracks,
Maiduguri, Borno State.

Yobe Sub-Office

Malari Layout,
Gubja Road,
Damaturu, Yobe State.

Sokoto Sub-Office

Umaru Muh'd Housing State Unit,
Yauri Flat, Beside Arewa Suya Spot,
Sokoto, Sokoto State.

Michika Sub-Office

No. 3, Ziradzala Store,
Opp. Local Government Secretariat,
Michika, Adamawa State.



HARAF

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...Reaching the Unreached without Barrier